

THYLORA · ErsatzReality

Original story · customer edition

The Handoff

A story about leadership, change, and making room without abandoning responsibility.



before sunrise · twenty-eight years



“PEOPLE THINK THIS IS A CEREMONY. IT IS AN INVENTORY.”

NORTH WORKS · TWENTY-EIGHT YEARS, HANDED OVER

FACTS

contracts
schedules
passwords
maintenance
risks

JUDGMENTS

who needs time
dangerous shortcuts
when a quiet room
means agreement
or fear

THINGS MARA MAY

BE WRONG ABOUT
“If I hand you only
my certainty, I am
handing you a cage.”

EDITION IDENTITY

The Handoff — A THYLORA Story About Leadership and Change

Document class	Customer story edition with discussion pages
Edition	Edition v2 · THY-ED2-20260917 · supersedes v1 (retained)
Audience	Working teams, successors, families; any reader facing a transfer
Purpose	A finished digital edition. Print it, mark it up, or use it on screen.
Subject	North Works, and a twenty-eight-year handover
Rights	Original THYLORA / ErsatzReality work. No third-party rights engaged.
Imagery	Vector inventory and decision plates drawn for this edition
Delivery	PDF download via the THYLORA library (checkout-email sign-in)

Truth boundary

North Works, Mara Venn and Eli Sorrel are original THYLORA characters. No real company, plant or person is depicted.

Recorded as unknown

- THYLORA graphic mark: recorded UNKNOWN / not approved. No logo is drawn.
- Brand font family: recorded UNKNOWN. Families used are PROPOSED — NOT CANON.
- QR destinations: none verified, so no QR is printed.

ONE

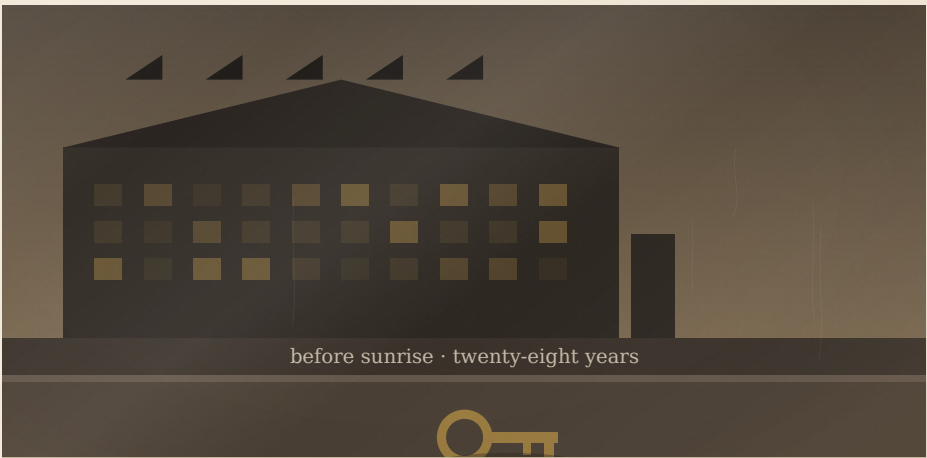
The Bell at North Works

For twenty-eight years, Mara Venn opened North Works before sunrise. She knew which press rattled in cold weather, which customer read every footnote, and which technician heard a bad bearing before the sensors did.

On Monday she placed the brass key on the conference table. Across from her sat Eli Sorrel, who would become director at month's end.

"People think this is a ceremony," Mara said. "It is an inventory." Eli opened his notebook. "Of what?"

"Everything I know that the building does not."



YEARS	OPENED	ON THE TABLE
Twenty-eight	Before sunrise, every day	The brass key

TWO

Three Lists

They made three lists. Facts held contracts, schedules, passwords, maintenance, and risks. Judgments held who needed time, which shortcuts were dangerous, and when a quiet room meant agreement or fear.

The third list was titled *Things Mara May Be Wrong About*. Eli looked at it. “You made this?”

“If I hand you only my certainty, I am not handing you leadership. I am handing you a cage.” For two weeks Eli shadowed Mara. For two more, Mara shadowed Eli. Staff could see who decided and why.

FACTS	JUDGMENTS	THINGS MARA MAY
contracts	who needs time	BE WRONG ABOUT
schedules	dangerous shortcuts	
passwords	when a quiet room	“If I hand you only
maintenance	means agreement	my certainty, I am
risks	or fear	handing you a cage.”

AN INVENTORY, NOT A CEREMONY

THE THREE LISTS · THE THIRD LIST IS THE HANDOFF

LIST ONE	LIST TWO	LIST THREE
Facts	Judgments	Things Mara May Be Wrong About

THREE

The Broken Press

Three days before the handoff, Press Four stopped. Mara knew the old workaround. Eli knew it violated the new safety procedure. Everyone looked at Mara.

She felt the familiar answer rise. Then she asked, “Eli, what do you need?”

“Twenty minutes, maintenance records, and permission to miss today’s target.” Mara gave all three. The team repaired the sensor properly, losing an afternoon and removing a failure that had returned six times.

“My shortcut would have worked,” Mara said later. “Today,” Eli replied. Mara smiled. “Good answer.”

THE SHORTCUT

works today
violates the new
safety procedure
failure returned 6×

WHAT ELI ASKED FOR

twenty minutes
maintenance records
permission to miss
today’s target

COST: ONE AFTERNOON · REMOVED: A REPEATING FAILURE

“MY SHORTCUT WOULD HAVE WORKED.” — “TODAY.”

THREE DAYS BEFORE

Press Four stopped

COST

One afternoon, one
missed target

REMOVED

A failure that had
returned six times

FOUR

The Door Opens Differently

On Eli’s first morning, Mara did not come early. He opened North Works, then replaced the single-key system with logged access for the people who needed it.

At ten, Mara arrived as a guest. Eli showed her the living handoff record: facts with sources, decisions with owners, assumptions marked for testing, and questions staff could add.

“You changed my system,” Mara said. “I thought that was the point.” “It was.” She returned the visitor badge.



THE FIRST THING ELI CHANGED · THE PREDECESSOR IS NOT PERFORMED, THE PURPOSE IS PROTECTED

WHAT COMPLETES A HANDOFF		
A handoff is complete when the next person can protect the purpose without performing the predecessor.		
FIRST MORNING	REPLACED	AT TEN
Mara did not come early	One key, with logged access	Mara arrived as a guest

USE IT

Talk together

Which knowledge belongs in a record, and which needs practice?

How did Mara keep responsibility without controlling Eli?

What should a successor preserve—and be free to redesign?

WORLD NOTE

The third list

Most handovers transfer the first two lists. The third one — *Things Mara May Be Wrong About* — is the one that makes the other two safe to inherit.

RIGHTS AND ORIGIN

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THE THREE LISTS · THE THIRD LIST IS THE HANDOFF

PLACE	CHARACTERS	RIGHTS
North Works	Original THYLORA characters	No real company or person depicted